

Chris Schulz



Team Lead | Product Manager | AI Engineer | AI Officer | Data Scientist | Data Strategist |

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📍 Potsdam, Germany |

Head of Data & AI with 10+ years taking AI from experiment to production in regulated FinTech and financial services. Track record of measurable commercial outcomes — 25% reduction in after-contact work, 40% development productivity uplift — alongside governance frameworks built for EU AI Act enforcement. Architects both the technology and the teams.

Professional Experience

Dr Klein Ratenkredit GmbH

HEAD OF DATA & AI

Lübeck, Germany

May 2023 – Present

- Built and scaled a 6-person AI engineering team from the ground up — establishing engineering standards, sprint cadences, and delivery operating model; structured technical training enabled all 6 engineers to independently operate platform components with 80% more efficient workflows
- Architected and deployed a production-grade AI platform for Intelligent Document Processing (IDP) using Strands Agents SDK and Amazon Bedrock AgentCore — end-to-end model serving, REST API layer, and CI/CD deployment pipelines — reducing after-contact work by 25%
- Designed and standardized an AI agent platform using the Model Context Protocol (MCP), enabling reusable API integrations across internal systems and standardizing agentic workflow orchestration company-wide
- Engineered a scalable distributed datalakehouse (AWS S3, Glue, Lake Formation, Firehose, DuckDB, Iceberg) with automated quality monitoring and full observability — the foundational data platform supporting analytics, ML training, and product data access across the organization
- Established an AI governance framework aligned with EU AI Act — encompassing model documentation, audit trails, explainability pipelines, and continuous bias monitoring for production decisioning systems
- Implemented Claude Code across the engineering team, driving a 40% increase in software development productivity

Amazon Bedrock AWS Claude Datalakehouse EU AI Act GenAI LLM MCP Model Governance Python Strands Agents

Allgeier IT GmbH

DATA SCIENTIST CONSULTANT

Berlin, Germany

Dec 2022 – May 2023

- Developed a data strategy and roadmap for a client's customer service department, identifying key business requirements and aligning data capabilities to operational goals
- Designed a cloud-based end-to-end data management framework covering ingestion, transformation, and consumption layers for scalable data democratization

Cloud Architecture Consulting Data Strategy Python

Deutsche Kreditbank AG (DKB)

LEAD DATA SCIENTIST

Berlin, Germany

Jul 2022 – Nov 2022

- Led and mentored a team of data scientists at one of Germany's largest digital retail banks, establishing standardized model development workflows, code review standards, and a regulated-deployment checklist for production ML systems in a banking environment
- Developed the data science strategy and product roadmap for DKB's core banking AI initiatives, aligning ML capability with BaFin-regulated risk and compliance constraints

BaFin Banking Data Science Strategy Data Science Workflow Python R Regulated ML Team Leadership

Europace AG

DATA SCIENTIST | TEAM LEAD CENTRAL DATA TEAM

Berlin, Germany

Jan 2021 – Jul 2022

- Led Europace's data strategy transformation, driving company-wide adoption of data-informed decision-making across all business units
- Architected and extended a central data lake with a modular service landscape, enabling self-serve analytics across all Europace stakeholder groups
- Developed and deployed ML-based anomaly detection and time series forecasting pipelines, automating data validation and enabling forward-looking capacity planning for executive reporting

Anomaly Detection AWS Datalake ML Python Team Leadership Time Series

DATA SCIENTIST | PRODUCT OWNER CENTRAL DATA TEAM

Jun 2020 – Jan 2021

- Designed the cloud-based data framework (ingestion → transformation → consumption) for the loans business and built KPI dashboards across teams, establishing the foundation for data-driven decision-making at Europace

AWS Datalake ETL KPI Design Product Deployment Python

DATA ANALYST LOANS BUSINESS

Aug 2016 – Jun 2020

- Advised partner institutions on technology innovation and data capability; led the Europace data-drivenness initiative enabling data-informed decision-making across the lending ecosystem

AWS Business Analytics Data Analysis Python R

Cerulli Associates

QUANTITATIVE ANALYST

London, UK

Oct 2015 – Aug 2016

- Provisioned data insights by sourcing, validating and analyzing data
- Executed model calibration, market sizing and forecasting of various European markets and asset classes
- Conducted research and captured distribution trends in institutional asset management along the institutional investment chain to calibrate client's market penetration strategies

Campaign M Financial Markets Forecasting Institutional Asset Management Quantitative Analysis

Lloyds Banking Group

BUSINESS ANALYST

Berlin, Germany

Mar 2014 – Oct 2015

- Designed asset allocation framework for an investment project targeting mass affluent clientele
- Developed a portfolio of investment vehicles covering the whole customer spectrum
- Created a selection algorithm utilising customer preferences, assessing qualitative and quantitative ETF characteristics to provide tailored investment advice

Asset Allocation ETF Financial Services Investment Retail Banking

Alstom Power

PROJECT MANAGEMENT TRAINEE

Zurich, Switzerland

Dec 2013 – Mar 2014

- Supported control and budgeting of the full project lifecycle from construction to commissioning of EMEA power plants, ensuring budget compliance across 4 projects
- Created and presented financial forecasts, construction reviews, cost calculation executions, and information database updates, ensuring clarity of information across stakeholders

Budgeting Controlling Financial Forecasting Project Management

Education

Leipzig University

MSC MANAGEMENT SCIENCE

Leipzig, GER / London, UK

Oct 2011 – Oct 2013

- Key areas: finance, accounting and taxation
- Dissertation: Portfolio Management and Overlay Strategies in Practice
- Semester abroad within Erasmus exchange program (University of East London)

Leipzig University

BSC ECONOMICS & MANAGEMENT SCIENCE

Leipzig, GER

Oct 2008 – Oct 2011

- Key areas: accounting, finance, macroeconomics
- Dissertation: Information Content of Lagged Equity and Bond Yields

Skills

Generative AI & LLMs

GenAI Patterns (RAG, Agents, Chain-of-Thought, ReAct, DSPy) | LLM Frameworks (Agno, CrewAI, HuggingFace, LangChain, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, Strands Agents) | Models & APIs (Anthropic, Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, HuggingFace, Ollama) | LLM Ops (Deployment, Monitoring) | Fine-tuning (PEFT, LoRA, QLoRA, RLHF, DPO, Unsloth) | Vector Databases (Amazon S3 Vectors, ChromaDB, FalkorDB, Qdrant) | Model Context Protocol (MCP Server Implementation, Client Integration)

ML & Data Science

Languages (Python, R, SQL, TypeScript) | Classical ML (Regression, Classification, Clustering, XGBoost, LightGBM, Scikit-learn) | Deep Learning (PyTorch, TensorFlow, Neural Networks, Transformers) | Time Series (Forecasting, Classification, Anomaly Detection, Nixtla) | Data Visualization (Plotly, Streamlit, Shiny) | Platform Engineering (Model Serving, API Design, Pipeline Orchestration, Standardized Deployment) | AWS (S3, Glue, Athena, DynamoDB, Firehose, ECS, Lambda, EventBridge, SageMaker) | Data Processing (Arrow, DuckDB, Apache Iceberg, Apache Spark, Pandas, Polars) | Databases (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, ElasticSearch, Redshift) | DevOps & Tools (Docker, Git, CI/CD via GitHub Actions, AWS CDK, Claude Code)

Platform & Data Eng.

Leadership & Strategy

Regulation

Team Building (AI Engineers, Data Engineers, ML Engineers, Hiring, Mentoring, Agile/Scrum) | Operating Model (Delivery Excellence, Engineering Standards, Cross-market Rollout) | Strategy (AI Roadmap, Data Strategy, Platform Vision, Stakeholder Management) | Regulation & Compliance (Data Protection, Data Privacy, Data Governance, Model Governance) | EU AI Act Compliance | Model Governance & Auditability | GDPR-Compliant ML Pipelines | Explainable AI (XAI) | Continuous Bias Monitoring | Data Quality Evaluation